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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **A week into the government shutdown**, businesses nationwide are starting to suffer, with some unable to pursue regulatory approvals, collect payments on contracts or secure federal-backed loans. **A1**
- ◆ **Microsoft scheduled an update of its Copilot AI assistant for release as soon as this month** that will reflect a collaboration between the company and Harvard Medical School. **A1**
- ◆ **Fed officials were divided** over how much further they should cut interest rates when they approved a reduction at their meeting last month, minutes show. **A2**
- ◆ **A rebound in tech stocks** helped lift the S&P 500 and Nasdaq by 0.6% and 1.1%, respectively, to records while the Dow was essentially flat. **B11**
- ◆ **Gold rose further** in what has become known as the de-basement trade to settle at \$4,043.30 a troy ounce. **B1**
- ◆ **Chinese gold-mining stocks** continued to surge as the metal reached its new milestone, buoyed by hedging. **B11**
- ◆ **U.S. regulators are investigating** Massachusetts Mutual Life Insurance over accounting practices in its investment operations. **B1**
- ◆ **SoftBank Group agreed** to a \$5.4 billion deal for the industrial-robotics-focused business of ABB. **B1**
- ◆ **GM abandoned a plan** to use its in-house auto finance company to extend the expired federal \$7,500 EV tax credit. **B3**
- ◆ **The U.K. corrected a statistical error**, effectively handing the Labour Party government the equivalent of \$4 billion it didn't know it had. **B3**

World- Wide

- ◆ **Israel and Hamas agreed** to a deal that would release all Israeli hostages held in the Gaza Strip in what is hoped to be the first step toward a durable peace. **A1, A6**
- ◆ **Former FBI Director James Comey pleaded not guilty** during his first court appearance in a criminal case that Trump publicly demanded be brought against one of his prominent critics. **A4**
- ◆ **Three scientists shared** the Nobel Prize in Chemistry for developing a porous form of molecular architecture. **A3**
- ◆ **Federal authorities arrested** a man accused of sparking a California blaze that became the Palisades fire, which destroyed thousands of homes and killed a dozen people. **A3**
- ◆ **Macron moved to name** a new prime minister rather than call elections, an approach that buys time to pull France out of fiscal disarray. **A6**
- ◆ **The Senate rejected** a resolution to curb Trump on his military strikes against boats in the Caribbean. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump escalated his battle** with Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson and Illinois Gov. JB Pritzker, saying they should be imprisoned. **A4**
- ◆ **The Trump administration said it isn't planning** to impose tariffs on generic drugs from foreign countries after months of wrangling. **A2**
- ◆ **The assailant in the attack** on a synagogue in Manchester, England, that left two dead claimed allegiance to Islamic State, police said. **A6**
- ◆ **Died: Joan Kennedy, 89**, ex-wife of Edward Kennedy. **A5**

CONTENTS	Markets.....	B11
Arts in Review.....	A11	Opinion.....
Business & Finance.....	B2-A6	Personal Journal.....
Business News.....	B3	Sports.....
Capital Account.....	A2	Technology.....
Crossword.....	A12	U.S. News.....
Heard on Street.....	B12	World News.....



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Israel, Hamas Agree on Hostage Deal

Captives would be released in first step to ending the Gaza war, Trump says

WASHINGTON—Israel and Hamas agreed Wednesday to a deal that would release all Israeli hostages held in the Gaza Strip in the first step toward peace after two years of war in the Palestinian territory. President Trump said the hostages will be released soon,

and that Israel will withdraw its troops in the strip to an agreed-upon area. Hamas confirmed that a broad deal, steered by U.S. envoys, had been reached to end the war, allow more humanitarian aid and facilitate “a prisoner exchange”—a reference to the release of Israeli hostages for Palestinians being held in Israeli prisons. Egyptian officials who mediated the talks said Hamas would let the remaining living hostages go as soon as Sunday

morning. Trump said in an interview with Fox News that the hostages would probably be released on Monday.

By Summer Said, Anat Peled and Abeer Ayyoub

“This is a GREAT Day for the Arab and Muslim World, Israel, all surrounding Nations, and the United States of America,” Trump wrote in a post on his Truth Social social media site.

The president’s announcement marked a breakthrough in what had been eight months of stalled negotiations after he took office, bringing Trump closer to a top foreign-policy goal of ending the war in Gaza. It came together in less than a month after an Israeli strike on Qatar, a U.S. ally that harbors Hamas officials, heightened fears the war was spinning out of control and brought new pressure on Israel from Trump and Hamas from leaders in the Muslim

world. Trump employed some of his most trusted advisers—his friend, real-estate investor Steve Witkoff, and son-in-law Jared Kushner—to bridge the gaps leading to Wednesday’s announcement. It is believed there are 20 living hostages of about 250 people kidnapped on Oct. 7, 2023, when Hamas and other

◆ **Families’ tense wait for hostages’ release.....** **A6**

Macron Struggles to Maintain Grip in French Crisis



REPRIEVE: President Emmanuel Macron of France, with his wife, Brigitte, outside the Elysée Palace on Wednesday, said he plans to name a new prime minister, shelving his threat of calling new elections to break a fiscal stalemate. **A6**

Shutdown Starting To Exact Its Toll on Business

Businesses nationwide are starting to feel the pain, one week into the U.S. government shutdown.

By Ruth Simon, Theo Francis and Lauren Weber

An Alameda, Calif., medical-device company postponed a planned spinoff, unable to pursue regulatory approvals. A Florida marketing company laid off five employees after receiving a stop-work order on a federal contract. A Minnesota subcontractor is trying to keep a half-dozen electricians working while it waits for a stalled government contract. The shutdown is disrupting business as usual in many ways—and reinforcing just how many private-sector operations depend on a federal bureaucracy humming on all cylinders. Government-backed small-business lending has ground to a halt. Agencies can’t award or make payments on many new contracts. Scheduled workplace-safety inspections are on hold and so are many regulatory reviews. Small government subcontractors such as Brian Butler’s marketing-and-communications firm said they are already

President Calling the Shots at DOJ

WASHINGTON—In his second term, President Trump has taken control of the Justice Department in ways he could have only dreamed of during his first.

By Josh Dawsey, Sadie Gurman and Aruna Viswanatha

Then, he publicly railed against senior department officials but largely heeded the

counsel of aides who urged him to trust the legal process. This term, all it took was one errand to get what he wanted. On Sept. 20, Trump meant to send a private message to Attorney General Pam Bondi urging her to prosecute former FBI Director James Comey and his other favored targets, according to U.S. officials familiar with the matter. “We can’t delay any longer, it’s killing our reputation and credibility,”

Trump wrote. Trump believed he had sent Bondi the message directly, addressing it to “Pam,” and was surprised to learn it was public, the officials said. Bondi grew upset and called White House aides and Trump, who then agreed to send a second post prising Bondi as doing a “GREAT job.” The misfire provided a window into how, through command and chaos, the president has executed a wholesale transformation of the Justice Department. Five days after the Saturday evening message, Comey was indicted. Comey pleaded not guilty to charges of false statements and obstruction on

◆ **Former FBI chief Comey pleads not guilty.....** **A4**
◆ **Trump calls for jailing of Illinois political rivals.....** **A4**

Trump Jr. Positioned To Benefit From Drug Overhaul

By ANNIE LINSKEY AND JOSH DAWSEY

WASHINGTON—The country’s top drugmakers are set to meet in early December at the Four Seasons hotel in Georgetown with Donald Trump Jr. and senior Trump administration officials that regulate the pharmaceutical industry. The host: BlinkRx, an online prescription-drug delivery company that in February installed Trump Jr. as a board member. The summit will conclude with a dinner at the Executive Branch, the exclusive new club founded by Trump Jr. and his close friends, according to people with knowledge of the event and a copy of the invitation viewed by The Wall Street Journal. BlinkRx stands to benefit from a shake-up of how patients buy drugs after President Trump urged pharmaceutical companies to sell their medicines directly to consumers. BlinkRx helps drugmakers do exactly that with a service that promises to set up direct-to-patient sales programs in as little as three weeks. TrumpRx, a new government web-

Please turn to page A2

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Have trip insurance? Read the fine print to make sure the right things are covered. **A9**

Hyundai Gets Cold Shoulder In Efforts to Appease Trump

The Korean carmaker bets big on U.S., but hasn’t reaped political benefits

By TIMOTHY W. MARTIN AND JIYOUNG SOHN

SEOUL—Hyundai Motor Group Executive Chair Euisun Chung hoped the automaker could appease the Trump administration with a series of aggressive moves to deepen its ties to the U.S. So far that looks like a painful miscalculation.

The immigration raid last month at Hyundai’s Georgia production complex, which resulted in more than 300 white-collar Korean workers in handcuffs and shackles, was the culmination of a year in which the world’s third-biggest carmaker repeatedly tried to assuage President Trump—but has little to show for it. Hyundai instead has become one of the

Please turn to page A8

The Craze Dividing Body Care: Trying to Smell Like a Doughnut

Dessert-scented soaps and deodorants are everywhere and many wonder why

By NATASHA KHAN

Paul and Anthony Fino were shopping at a Las Vegas mall when they started to hear the whispers. “That guy smells like a doughnut,” said one passerby. “Why does it smell like pancakes in here?” a shopper blurted out from an adjoining changing room at Zara. One person scurried away covering her nose, while another confronted Anthony more directly: “How can you handle smelling like that?”

They were doused in a fragrance called Caramel Swirl, a mashup of notes that they liked because it reminded them of Mrs. Butterworth’s syrup. As they fled the scene, the pair came to a realization: It might not be appropriate for every occasion. “I might draw the line at a strong vanilla in public settings like malls and gyms next time,” Anthony said. Fragrances that smell like food have been popular for years, but they used to come in flavors like vanilla or pumpkin

Please turn to page A10

Microsoft Seeks AI Path Independent of OpenAI

By SEBASTIAN HERRERA

Microsoft has a lofty goal: to become an AI chatbot powerhouse in its own right rather than leaning on its partnership with ChatGPT maker OpenAI. In an effort to steal a march on its more advanced rivals, the company has seized on healthcare as a lane in which it believes it can deliver a better offering than any of the other major players and build the brand of its Copilot assistant. A major update of Copilot scheduled for release as soon as this month will be the first to reflect a new collaboration between Microsoft and Harvard Medical School, people

familiar with the matter said. The new version of Copilot will draw on information from the university’s Harvard Health Publishing arm to respond to queries about healthcare topics. Microsoft will pay Harvard a licensing fee, one of the people said. In an interview, Dominic King, vice president of health at Microsoft AI, declined to discuss the arrangement with Harvard but said the company’s aim is for Copilot to serve answers that are more in line with the information users

Please turn to page A8

◆ **SoftBank’s AI footprint grows with robotics deal...** **B1**